University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Spring Semester 2026

8,003: RPV: Venturing in Emerging Trends - Entrepreneurship and Innovation in Practice

ECTS credits: 4

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Active participation, Analog, Individual work individual grade (10%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Presentation, Analog, Group work group grade (40%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Written work, Digital, Group work group grade (50%)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
8,003,1.00 RPV: Venturing in Emerging Trends - Entrepreneurship and Innovation in Practice -- English -- Siren Charlotta

Course information

Prerequisites

A basic understanding of entrepreneurship and innovation is helpful, yet not obligatory.

This course is assigned to the profile «Start-up & Scale-up Entrepreneurship», but can also be taken without selecting a specialisation.

Learning objectives

Having successfully taken this class, students will be able to:

- Understand and apply the basic frameworks explaining venturing in emerging trends
- Understand how entrepreneurial companies identify/derive new trends and opportunities
- Design innovative solutions for corporate challenges in the context of business innovation
- Evaluate solutions in accordance with their practical applicability and context-dependent value for practitioners as well as community stakeholders
- Work in teams to solve real venture challenges and present their findings in a compelling manner

Content

Students will work with Swisscom on real emerging opportunities and trends the company has identified but not yet developed solutions for, applying entrepreneurship and innovation frameworks to explore potential pathways forward. Rapid technological changes, shifting customer expectations, and evolving market dynamics are transforming supply chains, businesses, and entire industries. In such a dynamic context, approaches grounded in entrepreneurship and innovation can be used by new and established ventures alike to explore new solutions and drive value creation. “Intrapreneurs” are key to identifying business opportunities and delivering products and services that add value.

Working closely with representatives from Swisscom, students will tackle real challenges that fall at the intersection of innovation and entrepreneurship. Drawing on well-proven methodologies and frameworks, such as the External Enablement Framework for value creation, the Startup Navigator, and Human Centered Design Thinking, students will explore how innovation can be leveraged to help solve social or venture-related challenges in cooperation with company partner.

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

- This course counts 4 credits. Accordingly, the total workload for students is 120 hours. This includes self-study, campus time and all examinations.
- The structure of the contact study is planned as follows: 4 hours of introductory lectures; at least 12 hours of personal coaching; and 2 hours of excursions/guest lectures.
- The structure of the self-study is intended as follows: 4 hours of preparation time for the lectures and 70 hours for the examination 1 and 24 hours for the examination part 2.
- The course is conducted in presence in St.Gallen.

In this course, students work in teams to apply entrepreneurship and innovation methodologies to explore real emerging opportunities and trends that Swisscom has identified but not yet developed solutions for. The venture project is defined by the academic lecturer together with Swisscom. The venture has identified promising application areas for their technology and are interested in developing these new openings further. The venture projects each team has been working with will be presented in form of a presentation at the end of the semester. Furthermore, the results are submitted in a written project report form by each team at the end of the course and they will be shared with the company representatives.

The course is structured into six sessions: a kick-off day, an entrepreneurial method session, three team coaching sessions, and a final presentation day.

Kickoff Meeting: The course starts with a kick-off day including lectures about the main frameworks and topics relevant for the project. During the kick-off day Swisscom will introduce themselves and their business to the students. Students also have the opportunity to ask questions from the project partner. This first session is very important as the students will also be given guidelines and information about the successful completion of the venture project. The venture projects are done in teams, which will be formed in the first session. Students will form the teams themselves (i.e. no pre-assigned teams). If needed, the lecturer will assign students to the teams (e.g. in the case of uneven distribution of team members).

Entrepreneurial method session: In this session students will deep-dive into entrepreneurial methods that can be applied in the venture project.

Team coaching: Teams develop their projects independently. During the semester team coaching will be offered to the students. In these coaching sessions, academic advisors and practice partners give students methods and procedures on how to sharpen their project. Team coaching takes place in person. However, for scheduling reasons, the venture partner may join the coaching sessions remotely via Zoom.

Final presentation: In the final session, students will represent their results, and Swisscom representatives will be present to provide feedback.With the oral feedback the students receive concerning their presentations, the aim is that the teams will further develop their venture project before they will submit the final written project reports by the end of the semester.

Literature

The literature will be announced on StudyNet at the beginning of the course.

Additional information

In case of administrative and content-related questions, please contact Prof. Dr. Charlotta Sirén at charlotta.siren@unisg.ch or Dr. Michael Hudecheck at michael.hudecheck@unisg.ch.

Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Active participation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination

Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	10%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
Active in-class participation

Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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2. Examination sub part (2/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Presentation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Group work group grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
Presentation of venture project

Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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3. Examination sub part (3/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written work
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Written work
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	Off Campus
Grading type	Group work group grade
Weighting	50%
Duration	--

Languages

Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark

Written project report

Examination-aid rule

Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids

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Content

The guidelines for the written project report and presentations are presented within the kick-off lecture. The presentations take place in the last lecture. Students will receive oral feedback from the lecturer as well as the venture partner and are expected to incorporate this feedback into their final written project report. The written project report is due at the end of the semester.

Literature

Course literature will be announced via StudyNet at the beginning of the course.

Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW21) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 13 (Monday, 23rd March 2026) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 04 (Thursday, 22nd January 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 12 (Monday, 16 March 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 14 (Monday, 30 March 2026);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 15 (Monday, 06 April 2026).